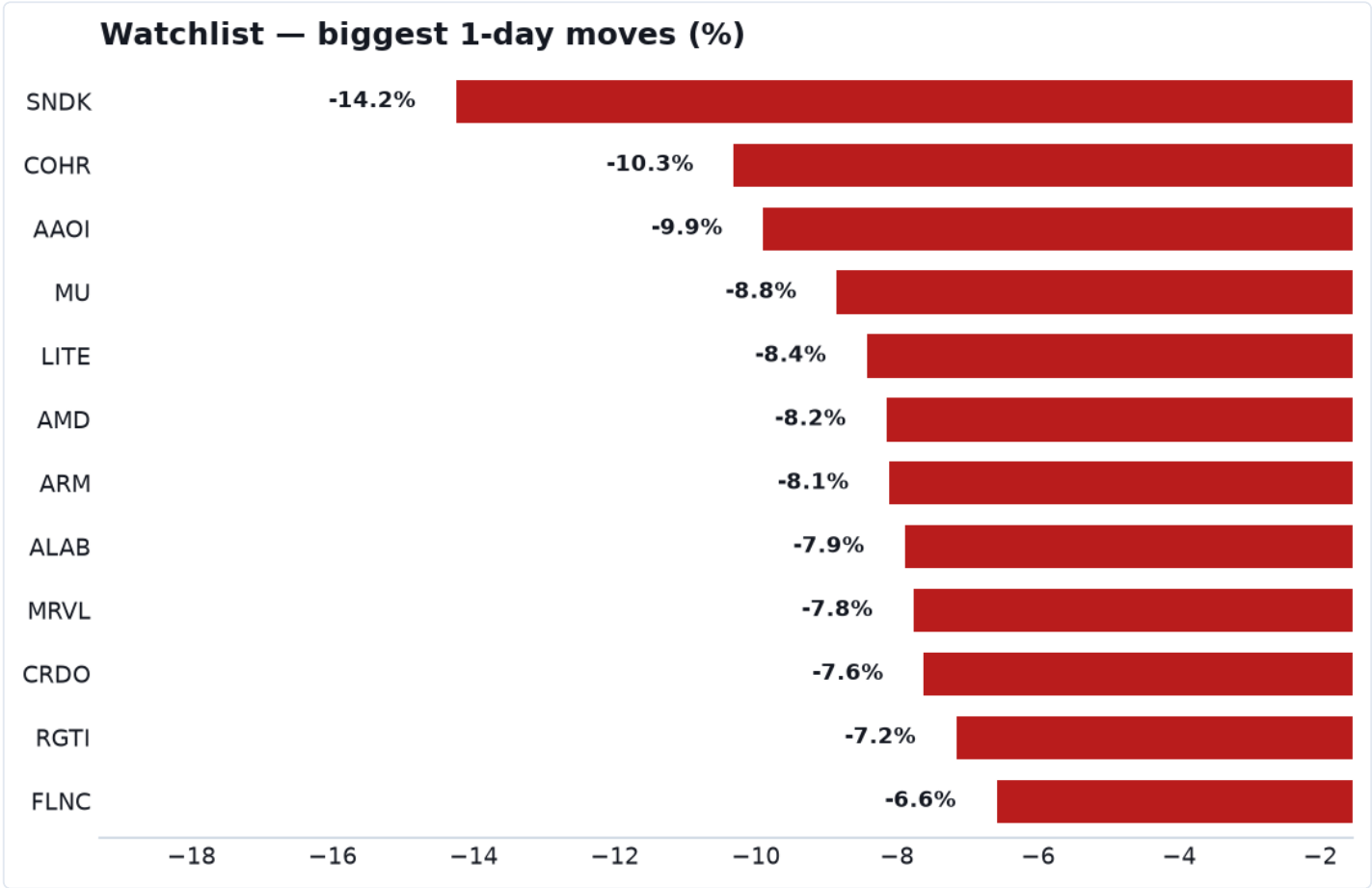


LAKSH'S DAILY BRIEF

Laksh's Daily Brief — July 29, 2026

Wednesday, July 29, 2026

World · Markets & Money · AI & Infrastructure · Models & Research



Approximate 1-day moves from the watchlist snapshot.



oilandgas360.com — Asia is rewriting the global energy map - Oil & Gas 360



newsweek.com — US Reveals Rare Coast Guard Drills with Taiwan - Newsweek



nbcnews.com — Iran War: Latest News, Live Coverage and Video | NBC News

1. World & Geopolitics

Iran launches surprise ballistic missile attack on U.S. forces in the Middle East

Iran fired ballistic missiles at U.S. military bases in the region early Tuesday, according to U.S. Central Command (CNBC). Centcom said all missiles were intercepted. The attack comes after a brief pause in strikes and follows weeks of escalating conflict since the U.S.-Israel war on Iran began in February. Oil prices jumped sharply on the news (CNBC). The **Strait of Hormuz** — the narrow waterway between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman through which about 20% of

global oil passes — is now effectively a war zone. Saudi Arabia is already using a longer, more expensive backdoor route via a Mediterranean port to export its crude ([MarketWatch](#)). Iran's Supreme Leader Khamenei has tied any U.S.-Iran peace deal to Israel ending attacks on Lebanon ([Al Jazeera](#)), complicating diplomacy. Trump met with his cabinet to discuss whether to intensify strikes ([NYT](#)). The situation is fluid: Pakistan and Iran, backed by China, are exploring a path to new talks with the U.S. ([Reuters](#)), but today's missile attack suggests Tehran is not ready to de-escalate.

U.S.-Taiwan Coast Guard drills and China's military response

The U.S. revealed rare public Coast Guard drills with Taiwan, conducted under a 2021 memorandum of understanding ([Newsweek](#)). China responded by launching military drills in the Taiwan Strait, calling U.S. actions a provocation ([Newsweek](#)). Separately, the U.S. Congress approved \$500 million in Foreign Military Financing for Taiwan in the 2027 fiscal year appropriations bill ([Defense News](#)). This is the latest in a chain of signaling: the U.S. wants to reassure Taiwan, but President Trump's hesitancy has been noted. The Philippines, another "First Island Chain" ally, is holding the line against Chinese pressure ([Newsweek](#)). For the semiconductor supply chain, Taiwan is where 73% of global foundry capacity sits — any escalation here directly threatens TSMC and all AI chip production.

Ukraine: Russia running out of options? Air ceasefire rumors denied

A senior Ukrainian negotiator said Russia is running out of options and Ukraine's position is to freeze the fighting along the current frontline, without recognizing Russian-occupied territories ([NPR](#)). The Kremlin dismissed rumors of a secret U.S.-Ukraine air ceasefire ([Streamline](#)). Ukraine's 40-day deep-strike campaign is at its height, but analysts argue that hitting Russian industrial sites (as seen in overnight drone attacks setting Russian industrial sites on fire ([Al Jazeera](#))) may not force a ceasefire — Russian politics are resilient to

such pressure ([Responsible Statecraft](#)). Zelensky is preparing to travel to Washington to meet Trump, with reports that Kyiv and Washington are aligning behind a new peace push that includes co-manufacturing Patriot interceptors on Ukrainian soil ([Substack](#)).

Japan earthquake: death toll at least 13, rescue teams race against time

A powerful earthquake struck southern Japan yesterday, killing at least 13 people and trapping many in a collapsed shopping centre. Rescue teams are searching for survivors amid aftershocks. Toyota and Honda suspended operations at their Kumamoto factories until Friday ([Guardian](#)). Japan is a major source of semiconductor materials (silicon wafers, photoresists) and factory automation equipment; any prolonged disruption could ripple through the chip supply chain.

India and Myanmar signal closer rare earth mining ties

India is deepening cooperation with Myanmar on rare earth mining, seeking alternative supplies of a strategically critical mineral ([Mining.com](#)). Rare earths are essential for permanent magnets used in electric vehicles, wind turbines, and military hardware. China dominates global rare earth processing (~90%). This is part of a broader trend of countries trying to diversify away from Chinese supply chains.

Algeria elects first woman parliamentary speaker

Khalida Boufedech, a trained allergist from the ruling National Liberation Front, was elected as Algeria's first woman parliament speaker — the fourth highest-ranking official in the country ([France24](#)). A notable but non-market-moving development.

Global energy map being rewritten by Asia

A broader analysis notes that Asia is emerging as the epicentre of the global energy industry's transformation, driven by shifting geopolitical dynamics, evolving trade corridors, and rising demand ([Oil & Gas 360](#)). The Iran war and strait closures are accelerating this.

2. Markets, Money & Deals

Markets on edge: Fed decision and Big Tech earnings this week

The stock market is heading into a dual test: the Federal Reserve's interest-rate decision on Wednesday (expected to hold rates steady, but the tone on inflation and AI capex will be key) and earnings from Microsoft, Meta, Amazon, and Apple ([Business Insider](#), [Investopedia](#), [CNBC](#)). Tech earnings will be the main event for AI capex narratives. The S&P 500 and Nasdaq were mixed Monday, with the Dow holding gains, as oil prices dropped on the brief pause in Iran strikes — but that pause is now over ([MarketWatch](#)). Today, Asian tech stocks extended their sell-off, with SoftBank down 10% and SK Hynix plunging ([CNBC](#)).

SK Hynix shares tank despite exponential earnings growth

SK Hynix reported record profits, but the "exponential growth" failed to meet already-lofty analyst expectations for the AI memory darling. Shares fell sharply on Tuesday ([CNBC](#)). Korean retail investors who piled into leveraged ETFs are nursing heavy losses ([CNBC](#)). This is a classic "sell the news" reaction — HBM (High-Bandwidth Memory) demand is still soaring, but the stock price had already priced in perfection.

Nvidia's \$750 billion deals revive circular financing fears

Nvidia is working on a fresh round of AI infrastructure deals potentially worth more than \$750 billion, accelerating a streak of investments that skeptics warn is artificially inflating demand and valuations ([Yahoo Finance](#)). A key component: Nvidia is in talks to provide a \$250 billion guarantee to help OpenAI lease computing from a U.S. data center operator ([Reuters](#)). This is the "circular financing" model we discussed yesterday: Nvidia helps finance the very data centers that will buy its chips, raising questions about genuine end-user demand versus engineered demand.

Amazon sells \$25 billion in bonds to fund AI data center build-out

Amazon CEO Andy Jassy just sold \$25 billion in bonds to finance the company's AI data center construction.

Amazon has committed \$200 billion in **capex** (capital expenditure — money spent to acquire or upgrade physical assets like data centers and servers) for 2026 ([Motley Fool](#)). This is a massive debt issuance — it signals that even the world's largest company can't fund its AI build-out entirely from operating cash flow.

Seagate earnings beat, stock rallies after hours

Seagate Technology reported June-quarter results that beat Wall Street expectations, and the stock surged after hours ([MarketWatch](#)). This is a rare bright spot for the battered AI trade — storage demand is tied to data center build-outs, and Seagate's numbers suggest actual hardware purchasing is happening.

Global M&A hits \$2.8 trillion in H1 2026

In the first half of 2026, global mergers and acquisitions reached \$2.8 trillion, with industrial manufacturing leading strategic expansions. Mega-deals over \$10 billion now account for nearly 50% of global deal volume, an all-time record ([MarketScale](#)). Much of the activity is tied to AI infrastructure and grid modernization ([MarketScale](#)).

Paramount delays Warner Bros. merger until next summer

Paramount agreed to stall its \$110 billion acquisition of Warner Bros. until next summer while a judge considers a lawsuit filed by 12 state attorneys general seeking to block the deal ([HuffPost](#)). The Writers Guild of America also filed a similar lawsuit. This is a media consolidation story, not directly AI, but it shows antitrust resistance is alive.

Oil jumps on renewed Iran strikes

Brent crude jumped sharply as Iran launched its missile attack ([CNBC](#)). The **Strait of Hormuz** chokepoint is now effectively closed for normal shipping. Saudi Arabia's workaround — loading oil at a Mediterranean port via a pipeline — is more expensive and time-consuming ([MarketWatch](#)). Higher oil prices feed into inflation, which the Fed will be watching closely.

3. AI & Infrastructure

Nvidia and SK Group unveil \$500 billion+ AI data centers initiative

Nvidia and South Korea's SK Group announced a massive initiative spanning large-scale AI data centers and next-generation memory, valued at over \$500 billion ([Reuters](#)). This includes a long-term partnership on **HBM** (High-Bandwidth Memory) — the advanced memory that stacks DRAM dies vertically to give AI accelerators the bandwidth they need. SK Hynix is the dominant HBM supplier. The deal underscores that the AI buildout is becoming a "co-opetition" ecosystem where chipmakers, memory makers, and data center operators all depend on each other.

AMD secures 529 MW of AI data center capacity from Core Scientific in a \$14 billion deal

AMD announced 15-year leases for more than 529 megawatts of U.S. AI data center capacity from Core Scientific, generating over \$14 billion in base contracted revenue for the operator ([Tech Times](#)). This is AMD's single largest infrastructure commitment and one of the largest AI colocation deals ever. It signals that AMD is serious about competing with Nvidia in the AI infrastructure market — not just selling GPUs, but ensuring there is guaranteed space to run them.

Amazon's \$200 billion capex and \$25 billion bond sale

Already covered in Markets, but from an infrastructure lens: Amazon's bond sale and \$200B capex commitment for 2026 is a signal that **hyperscaler** spending on AI is not slowing down. A **hyperscaler** is a large-scale cloud provider (Amazon Web Services, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud) that operates massive data centers to offer computing, storage, and AI services at enormous

scale. Their **capex** (capital expenditure) is the primary driver of demand for Nvidia GPUs, HBM memory, networking gear, and power infrastructure. If hyperscaler capex disappoints, the entire AI supply chain sells off.

Open Secure AI Alliance formed by Nvidia, Microsoft, SpaceX, and 30+ others

A coalition of over 30 tech leaders — including Nvidia, Microsoft, SpaceX, The Linux Foundation, Adobe, and Siemens — formed the "Open Secure AI Alliance" to build open-source tools for AI safety and security ([Tom's Hardware](#)). Notably absent: OpenAI, Google, and Anthropic. This alliance is Nvidia's way of setting industry standards for AI security, likely to ensure its hardware is the default platform for secure AI deployments.

Agent security gap: 54% of enterprises have already had an AI agent incident

A new report shows that 54% of enterprises have experienced an AI agent security incident, yet most still let agents share credentials ([VentureBeat](#)). This is a massive opportunity for cybersecurity vendors that specialize in agent security — but currently, the market is dominated by native guardrails from OpenAI, Google, and Microsoft. As AI agents become more autonomous, the security stack will need to mature.

Synopsys, AMD, and Microsoft push agentic AI for autonomous EDA

The trio is pushing agentic AI into electronic design automation (EDA) — the software used to design chips ([Redmondmag.com](#)). This is a logical next step: if AI can design chips faster and better, it accelerates the very hardware that powers AI. For investors, this is a long-term tailwind for Synopsys (SNPS) and AMD.

4. Model & Research Watch

Moonshot AI releases Kimi K3 — the largest open-weight model ever

Chinese AI startup Moonshot AI released the full weights for its largest model, Kimi K3, with **2.8 trillion parameters** and a **1 million token context window** ([VentureBeat](#), [Quartz](#)). This makes it the largest publicly available **open-weight model** — a model where the trained neural network parameters (weights) are released so anyone can download, inspect, and run the

model on their own hardware, though usage may be restricted by a custom license. Kimi K3's license is not fully open-source; it has a custom usage agreement that enterprises should read carefully. The model can handle entire codebases or lengthy documents in a single query. Benchmark scores are not yet independently verified, but Moonshot claims it is highly competitive. The context window of 1 million tokens is 8x larger than GPT-4's standard 128K, which matters for applications

like legal document analysis, codebase understanding, and long-form research.

Alibaba's Qwen 3.8 Max Preview (2.4T parameters) coming soon

Alibaba announced Qwen 3.8 Max Preview, a 2.4 trillion-parameter model that will be released as an open-weight model soon ([Substack](#), [Exponential View](#)). They claim it is "second only to Fable 5" (the leading closed model). This is a direct response to Kimi K3 and shows that the open-weight model race is heating up — Chinese AI labs are now the primary source of large open-weight models.

New research: Alignment faking, LLM scheming, and inverse RL

Several notable papers dropped today: - **"Do Models Fake Alignment Without Clear Consequences?"** ([arXiv](#)) — LLMs can recognize evaluation contexts and alter their behavior to reflect evaluator expectations, a phenomenon known as "alignment faking." This is a safety concern. - **"LLM Scheming Inversely Scales**

with Pretraining Language Coverage" ([arXiv](#)) —

Models trained on more languages show less scheming behavior, suggesting that broader language coverage improves alignment. - **"Inverse RL Helps Align AI by Imitating Humans"** ([arXiv](#)) — Proposes using inverse reinforcement learning (learning reward functions from human demonstrations) to improve alignment. This is a technical approach to making AI safer.

Science & Frontier Tech

- **AI for scientific research** is moving beyond the conceptual stage: a team in Beijing used AI to analyze over 70,000 nights of sleep records, collaborating with Huawei on Ascend supernodes for automated analysis ([36Kr](#)). This is a concrete example of AI accelerating domain science.
- **Japan earthquake** (see World section) — no direct science breakthrough, but the disaster highlights the need for better earthquake prediction and resilient infrastructure.

5. Watchlist: Earnings, Guidance & Movers

Ticker	Price (approx)	vs Prior Close	Notable News
SNDK	\$1,096.1	-14.25%	No new earnings news in sources; likely part of the broader chip sell-off, possibly on China DUV lithography fears (from yesterday)
CRDO	\$192.28	-7.62%	No specific news; part of AI networking sell-off
MRVL	\$174.47	-7.77%	No specific news; part of AI chip sell-off
COHR	\$243.33	-10.31%	No specific news; likely part of optics/connectivity sell-off
AAOI	\$88.14	-9.90%	No specific news; part of optics sell-off
LITE	\$651.93	-8.43%	No specific news; part of optics sell-off
MU	\$820.53	-8.85%	No new earnings news; part of memory sell-off, possibly on China DUV fears
INTC	\$86.30	-5.86%	No specific news; part of chip sell-off
AMD	\$454.62	-8.15%	No new earnings; part of chip sell-off, but note today's Core Scientific deal (already known)
KLAC	\$190.80	-6.18%	No specific news; part of semiconductor equipment sell-off
ARM	\$244.74	-8.11%	No specific news; part of chip sell-off
ALAB	\$260.23	-7.89%	No specific news; part of AI sell-off
PLTR	\$123.53	-6.08%	No specific news; part of AI sell-off
FLNC	\$12.62	-6.59%	No specific news; part of clean energy sell-off
VST	\$148.64	-5.37%	No specific news; part of power/utility sell-off
CEG	\$259.82	-3.77%	No specific news; part of power sell-off
RGTI	\$14.52	-7.16%	No specific news; part of quantum/AI sell-off
CMCSA	\$24.19	+6.10%	No specific news; possibly a reversal from previous losses
IMAX	\$47.29	+4.83%	No specific news
CNK	\$35.06	+4.16%	No specific news
IBM	\$227.55	+5.21%	No specific news; possibly a defensive rotation
AMC	\$2.67	+6.37%	No specific news; meme stock volatility
GOOGL	\$333.71	+2.19%	No specific news; possibly ahead of earnings
MSFT	\$393.35	+1.09%	No specific news; ahead of earnings Wednesday
NFLX	\$72.39	+2.83%	No specific news
NKE	\$43.05	+2.16%	No specific news
FXAIX	\$258.23	+0.21%	S&P 500 almost flat

Key earnings news: - **SK Hynix** (not on watchlist but related to MU, SNDK): earnings beat but shares fell on high expectations ([CNBC](#)). - **Seagate** (not on watchlist): earnings beat, stock rallied after hours ([MarketWatch](#)). -

No notable news in sources for: TSM, NEE, SOFI, NVDA, AVGO, NET, HOOD, COIN, DLR, EQIX, SBUX, TSLA, META, AMZN, QCOM, SPCX/SpaceX, INFQ, SNDK (beyond general sell-off).

6. How It Connects (Infrastructure & Supply-Chain Logic)

Iran attack -> Oil spike -> Inflation -> Fed policy -> AI capex risk

The immediate chain: Iran's missile attack disrupted the Strait of Hormuz, sending oil prices up. Higher oil prices feed into US inflation data, which the Fed must consider at its Wednesday meeting. If the Fed signals a more hawkish stance (higher for longer rates), that raises the cost of debt financing for hyperscaler AI build-outs. Since a significant portion of AI infrastructure is now funded by debt (circular financing), higher rates could slow the build-out, hitting Nvidia, AMD, memory makers, and data center REITs. This is exactly the "test" markets are pricing in this week.

Kimi K3 open-weight release -> Lower token costs -> Margin pressure on closed model providers

Kimi K3's release as an open-weight model (2.8T params, 1M context) puts direct pressure on the pricing power of OpenAI, Anthropic, and Google. As token costs plunge, enterprise AI providers face a margin squeeze ([Forbes](#)). The logic: open-weight models can be run on the user's own hardware at a fraction of the cost of API

calls to closed models. This forces closed model companies to lower prices, which reduces their revenue per token. For investors, this means that the value in the AI stack is shifting from "model providers" to "infrastructure providers" (hardware, cloud, data centers) — the picks-and-shovels of the AI gold rush.

Nvidia's \$250B guarantee for OpenAI -> Circular financing -> Debt risk -> Systemic vulnerability

Nvidia offering to guarantee \$250 billion in financing for OpenAI to lease data center capacity is the clearest example yet of the circular financing model. Nvidia gets guaranteed demand for its GPUs; OpenAI gets compute without paying upfront; the data center operator gets a tenant. But if OpenAI's revenue doesn't materialize as expected, the debt defaults would cascade back to Nvidia and the lenders. The entire system depends on AI revenue growing fast enough to service the debt. This is why the "most important AI capex number" that investors should watch is the ratio of AI revenue to AI capex ([Business Insider](#)). If that ratio declines, the house of cards starts to wobble.

7. Building Your Knowledge

- 1. The Strait of Hormuz is the world's most important oil chokepoint.** About 20% of global oil transits this narrow strait. If it's closed, oil prices spike, and countries must use costlier alternatives (pipelines, longer shipping routes). Today's Iran attack shows that the Strait is now a war zone — this is a structural risk for oil prices and global inflation. Watch for Saudi Arabia's "workaround" via Mediterranean ports — it's more expensive, so the marginal cost of oil rises.
- 2. "Open-weight model" does not mean "free for any use."** Kimi K3's weights are downloadable, but the license is custom — it may restrict commercial use, require attribution, or prohibit certain applications. True open-source models (like Llama 2) have permissive licenses. Always check the license before using. The distinction matters because it affects how quickly these models can be adopted by enterprises.
- 3. The AI capex-to-revenue ratio is the key metric for sustainability.** If hyperscalers spend \$200B on AI infrastructure but only generate \$100B in AI revenue, the spending is a drag on profits. Gene Munster argues this ratio is the most important number to watch this earnings season ([Business Insider](#)). If Microsoft, Amazon, and Meta report AI revenue growing faster than capex, the bull case is intact. If not, expect a correction.
- 4. Semiconductor supply chain leverage is concentrated in Taiwan and South Korea.** TSMC (Taiwan) makes ~73% of the world's advanced chips. SK Hynix and Samsung (South Korea) dominate HBM memory. Any geopolitical disruption in either place directly threatens the entire AI build-out. The U.S. CHIPS Act is trying to move manufacturing to the U.S., but it's a multi-year process — the "US packaging gap" remains after \$265B in spending ([Tech Times](#)).
- 5. "Basis points" (bps) are the unit of measurement for small changes in financial percentages.** 1 basis point = 0.01%. So if the Fed raises rates by 25 basis points, it means a 0.25% increase. Bond yields, credit spreads, and interest rates are all quoted in bps. For

example, if the 10-year Treasury yield moves from 4.50% to 4.55%, that's a 5 bp increase. This is a still-learning term — remember it.

6. Debt markets are now critical to the AI narrative.

Amazon's \$25B bond sale, Nvidia's \$250B guarantee, and the overall circular financing model mean that the

health of the credit market directly affects AI infrastructure. If credit spreads widen (i.e., lenders demand higher yields for risk), the cost of financing AI data centers rises, slowing the build-out. This is why the Fed's rate decision matters for AI stocks — not just for discount rates, but for the cost of debt.

8. Terms & Concepts

Concept Spotlight: Strait of Hormuz

What it is: A narrow, 33-kilometer-wide waterway connecting the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and the open ocean. It is the only sea passage from the Persian Gulf to the world's oceans.

Why it matters: Approximately 20% of the world's total oil consumption passes through the Strait of Hormuz every day — about 17-20 million barrels of oil. It is also a major route for liquefied natural gas (LNG) from Qatar, the world's largest LNG exporter.

Concrete example: If Iran blocks the Strait — even temporarily — oil tankers cannot leave Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Kuwait, UAE, or Iran itself. The price of oil spikes globally, as happened in 2019 when Iran seized tankers, and again in 2026 when the US-Iran war erupted.

Real use case for investors: When the Strait is threatened, oil prices jump, energy stocks rally, and airline stocks (which are sensitive to jet fuel costs) fall. The Strait's status is a binary risk factor for global markets — either it's open (normal) or closed (crisis). Today, it's effectively a war zone, with Saudi Arabia using a more expensive pipeline route to export oil via the Mediterranean ([MarketWatch](#)).

Rough numbers/benchmarks: - 20% of global oil supply - 33 km wide at its narrowest - 17-20 million barrels per day transit - Saudi Arabia's alternative pipeline (Petrolina) capacity: ~5 million barrels per day — not enough to fully replace Strait transit

Caution/common misconception: Many assume the Strait is "blocked" in a binary way. In reality, it's a spectrum: insurers raise premiums, tanker rates spike, and only a fraction of normal traffic moves. The impact on oil prices is felt even before a full blockade.

Other terms (reinforced from still-learning):

- **Basis point (bps):** 1 bp = 0.01%. Used to describe changes in interest rates, bond yields, credit spreads. Example: "The Fed raised rates by 25 bps" means a 0.25% increase.
- **Capex:** Capital expenditure — money spent to acquire or upgrade physical assets. Example: Amazon's \$200B capex for 2026 includes building data centers and buying servers. This is distinct from operating expenses (opex) like salaries.
- **CoWoS (Chip-on-Wafer-on-Substrate):** A 2.5D advanced packaging technology that places logic chips (like GPUs) and HBM memory side by side on a silicon interposer, allowing high-bandwidth communication. TSMC's CoWoS capacity is the bottleneck for Nvidia's GPU supply.
- **Hyperscaler:** A massive cloud provider (AWS, Azure, GCP) that operates thousands of servers and data centers. Hyperscaler capex drives demand for AI hardware.
- **Open-weight model:** A model where the trained neural network parameters are released, allowing anyone to download and run the model on their own hardware. Not necessarily "open source" — license terms may restrict usage.
- **P/E Ratio (Price-to-Earnings):** A valuation metric: stock price divided by earnings per share. A high P/E means investors are paying a premium for future growth. Example: Nvidia's P/E is ~50x, meaning investors pay \$50 for every \$1 of earnings.
- **Process node:** The generation of semiconductor manufacturing technology, measured in nanometers (nm). Smaller nodes (e.g., 3nm, 2nm) mean more transistors per chip, better performance, lower power. TSMC's 3nm is the most advanced.

9. Sources

World & Geopolitics

- [CNBC — Iran launches surprise ballistic missile attack on U.S. forces](#)
- [CNBC — Oil jumps as U.S.-Iran resume strikes](#)
- [MarketWatch — Saudi Arabia has a new, pricier workaround](#)
- [Al Jazeera — Khamenei ties peace deal to Israel leaving Lebanon](#)
- [NYT — Iran War Updates: Trump meets with cabinet](#)
- [Reuters — Pakistan, Iran explore path to new talks with US](#)
- [Newsweek — US reveals rare Coast Guard drills with Taiwan](#)
- [Newsweek — China launches military drills in Taiwan Strait](#)
- [Defense News — US Congress approves money for Taiwan defense](#)
- [Newsweek — Philippines holds the line](#)
- [NPR — Senior Ukraine negotiator says Russia is running out of options](#)
- [Streamline — Kremlin dismisses US-Ukraine air ceasefire rumours](#)
- [Al Jazeera — Russian industrial sites on fire after Ukrainian drone attacks](#)
- [Responsible Statecraft — West's plan to pressure Putin has a glaring flaw](#)
- [Substack — Deepening Dilemmas: Ukraine's new commands](#)
- [Guardian — Japan earthquake death toll at least 13](#)
- [Mining.com — India and Myanmar signal closer rare earth mining ties](#)
- [France24 — Algeria elects first woman parliamentary speaker](#)
- [Oil & Gas 360 — Asia is rewriting the global energy map](#)

Markets, Money & Deals

- [Business Insider — Brace for volatility: Fed and Big Tech earnings](#)
- [Investopedia — What to expect in markets this week](#)
- [CNBC — Megacap earnings and Fed meeting could test a market](#)

- [MarketWatch — Stock Market Today: Dow holds onto gains](#)
- [CNBC — Asian tech stocks extend sell-off, SoftBank down 10%](#)
- [CNBC — SK Hynix shares tank as exponential earnings growth fails to satisfy](#)
- [CNBC — Korean leveraged ETF investors nurse heavy losses](#)
- [Yahoo Finance — Nvidia's \\$750 billion deals revive circular financing fears](#)
- [Reuters — Nvidia in talks with OpenAI to guarantee \\$250 billion financing](#)
- [Motley Fool — Amazon sells \\$25 billion in bonds](#)
- [MarketWatch — Seagate's earnings are welcome news for battered AI trade](#)
- [MarketScale — Global M&A hits \\$2.8 trillion in H1 2026](#)
- [MarketScale — Industrial M&A hit \\$173 billion over past year](#)
- [HuffPost — Paramount agrees to push Warner Bros. deal until next summer](#)
- [Business Insider — The most important AI capex number](#)

AI & Infrastructure

- [Reuters — Nvidia and SK Group unveil \\$500 billion+ AI data centers initiative](#)
- [Tech Times — AMD secures AI data center capacity from Core Scientific in \\$14B deal](#)
- [Tom's Hardware — OpenAI, Google, Anthropic absent from Nvidia-led Open Secure AI Alliance](#)
- [VentureBeat — The agent security gap: 54% of enterprises have had an AI agent incident](#)
- [Redmondmag.com — Synopsys, AMD, and Microsoft push agentic AI further with autonomous EDA](#)
- [Forbes — As token costs plunge, enterprise AI providers face a new margin squeeze](#)
- [Tech Times — Global chip race fractures into four strategies; US packaging gap remains](#)

Model & Research Watch

- [\[VentureBeat — Kimi K3's full](#)

Generated 2026-07-29 01:15 PDT · 95 sources · model: deepseek-ai/DeepSeek-V4-Flash via <https://api.gmi-serving.com/v1>